

Pluto+ SDR Troubleshooting Guide

ECSE 4560/6560: Modern Communication Systems

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This file compiles common issues encountered when using Pluto+ SDR and provides possible solutions.

Hardware Check

1. SDR DATA port is well connected to the computer USB port.
2. The cable is not charge-only.
3. The USB port supplies power.
4. Connect two antennas to Tx1 and Rx1 port.
5. Device purchased from [Evalms](#). User manual is available [online](#).

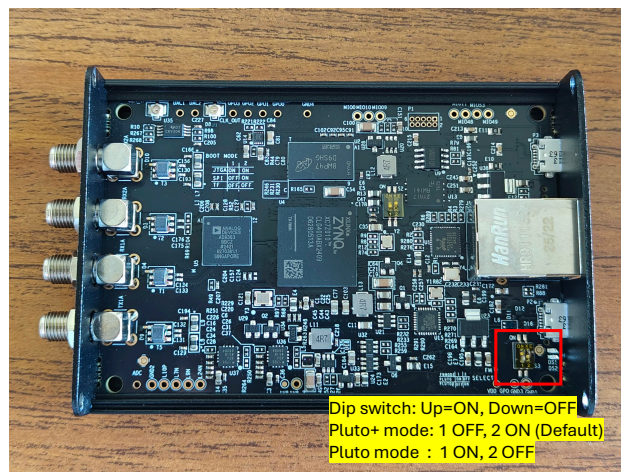


Figure 1: Pluto+ SDR modes. Pluto mode is more stable. Warning! Don't try both switch ON-unstable mode.

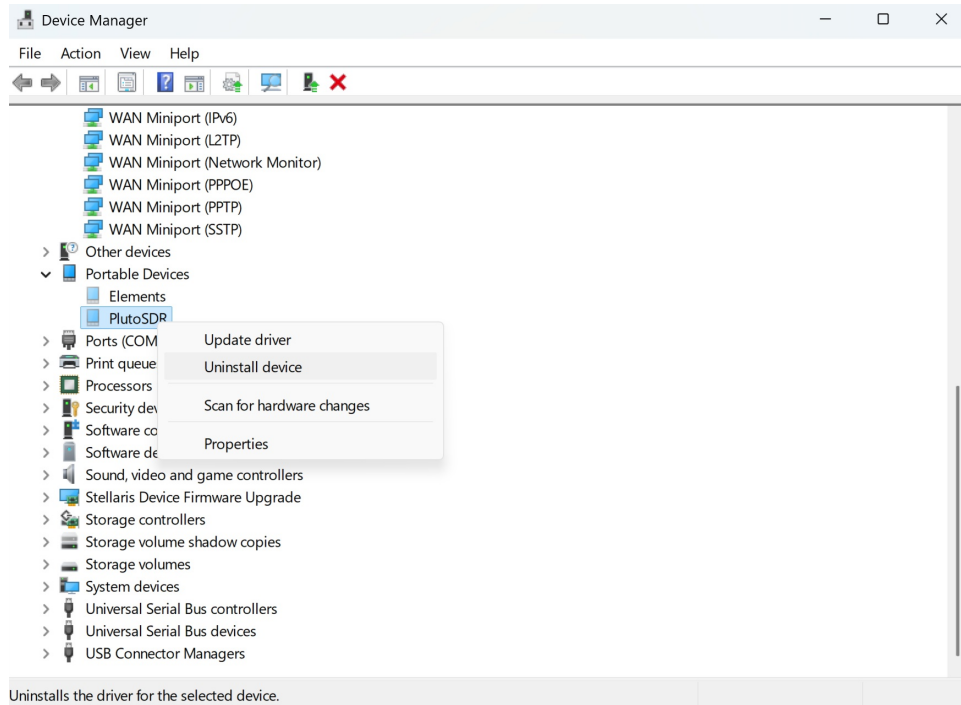


Figure 2: Device Manager on Windows.

First-time Use: MATLAB Pluto Add-On fails to connect SDR

1. Download the [PLUTO firmware](#) (don't unzip it). Move the zip file to the PlutoSDR USB drive. Right-click on PlutoSDR in the file explorer to eject it (don't use the taskbar to eject). Keep the SDR plugged in (verify that green light starts blinking rapidly), and wait until it reconnects automatically or green light stops blinking rapidly.
2. Go to the Pluto Radio Add-On installation. MATLAB will suggest updating the firmware. Follow the MATLAB guides. After ejection, if the SDR does not reconnect automatically, ensure the LEDs are not blinking rapidly. Then, unplug and replug the SDR to establish the connection.

Second-time Use: SDR does not appear in file explorer on Windows PC

1. Go to Control Panel -> Device Manager -> view -> show hidden devices. The hidden devices will be shown in gray. As shown in Fig. 2
2. Expand all device lists and uninstall all gray devices that include 'Pluto' or 'SDR' in their names. Also uninstall 'USB Mass Storage Device' in the list 'Universal Serial Bus Controllers'. If there pops up a window for deleting local files, check the box to delete.
3. Unplug the SDR, then replug in after 10 seconds.
4. If the issue persists, restart the computer and then replug in the SDR.